



Wearable computing

Shrinking digital technology has made it possible to build computers into clothing, jewelry, and lightweight headsets to give convenient access to information, monitor health and fitness, and even create 3-D game experience. Many wearables, such as smartwatches and pendants, usually work together with a smartphone or tablet computer carried by the user.



Google Glass

This innovative, head-worn, voice-controlled display projects information in front of a user's eyes for hands-free computing and communication.



Fitness trackers

Sensors inside this gadget measure the speed, distance, and duration of an exercise undertaken by a person to give feedback on particular fitness targets.



Smartwatches

These wrist-worn devices run apps such as those notifying a user about a message, or pointing out the user's real-time position on a map.

Lights can be programmed, or switched on, off, or dimmed.



Music can be selected and played in any or all rooms.



Electronic locks can be checked, locked, and unlocked.



Security cameras can be made to stream images of house interiors.



Internet of Things

It is not just people who can connect to each other using computers and smartphones. The Internet of Things (IoT) connects many devices—from heating systems to vehicles—over the Internet, allowing them to be accessed remotely. The devices communicate with each other, leading to fully controllable smart homes.



Home heating and cooling can be adjusted.



Using an app to connect to devices remotely

1997

The WiFi standard (a set of specifications) was introduced for wireless network connections. The first WiFi routers (devices that control the flow of data) for personal computers appeared two years later.

2008

The first version of the Android operating system for phones and tablet computers was released. By 2016, two-thirds of all mobile devices would be powered by Android.

2013

Amazon and DHL tested their first delivery drones. These unmanned aerial vehicles could quickly deliver essential products to hard-to-reach places.

2015

More than half of all of the 100 billion searches on Google each month were from mobile devices such as smartphones and tablet computers instead of desktop computers.

Delivery drone

